property; abjure violence; ensure education for children aged 6-14; and protect and improve the natural environment. In essence, the behavioural revolution India needs is already envisioned in its founding document. All we need to do is to put it into practice.

One could learn from the example of Singapore, a nation that transitioned from a third-world country to a first-world powerhouse within decades. Its transformation was not merely the result of shrewd economic policy but equally of cultivating civic consciousness and collective responsibility. Similarly, South Korea's rise from corruption-ridden governance to a top economy or Japan's post-war civic discipline leading to its industrial boom are enough evidence that responsible social behaviour is not just desirable but essential.

Other countries that rank high on human development indices—Sweden, Switzerland and Germany—exhibit a strong culture of public responsibility, too. Consider Switzerland, where public transport runs with clockwork precision and fare evasion is an alien concept. This is no reflection of efficient enforcement but a social trust that connects individual behaviour to collective outcomes.

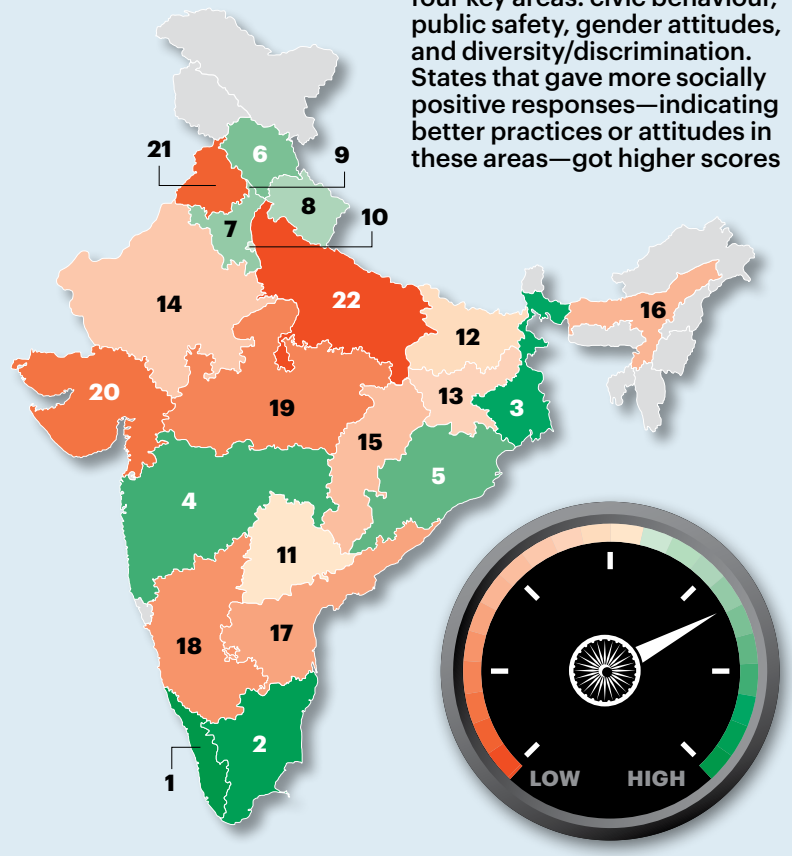
INDIA'S ECONOMIC ASCENDANCY HAS NOT SEEN A CORRESPONDING ELEVATION IN CIVIC BEHAVIOUR, EQUITY OR SOCIAL RESPONSIBILITY

PM Modi has consistently championed this message of collective responsibility through transformative initiatives such as the Swachh Bharat Mission and Beti Bachao Beti Padhao. The India Today Gross Domestic Behaviour survey aims to hold a mirror to our society, and offer the nation an opportunity to contemplate its collective progress along this multidimensional journey toward true development. To create a sense of healthy competition among states to achieve the desired social behaviour, the survey has ranked them based on their attitudes across four key dimensions: Civic Behaviour, which assessed participation in the common good and adherence to public rules; Public Safety, which measured trust in law enforcement and perceptions of personal security; Gender Attitudes, which evaluated views on gender roles and equality; and Diversity and Discrimination, which examined biases related to caste, religion and ethnicity (*see methodology*).

The findings across the four domains give us a nuanced portrait of a geographically diverse society in transition, where conservative values coexist with modernising impulses. The regional variations—from Kerala to Uttar Pradesh—suggest that India encompasses multiple civic realities, each with different developmental implications. Encouragingly, there is a rising sense of responsibility and determination to set things

HOW THE STATES BEHAVE

This composite ranking represents how 21 states and one Union Territory performed based on their responses to 30 different questions. These questions were grouped into four key areas: civic behaviour, public safety, gender attitudes, and diversity/discrimination. States that gave more socially positive responses—indicating better practices or attitudes in these areas—got higher scores



Graphics by TANMOY CHAKRABORTY